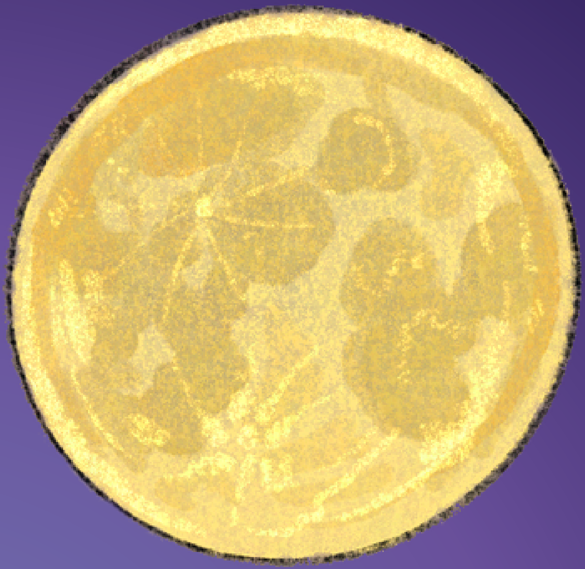
SPARKJAM 2025



LUCKYDUX

Moonlit Memories

Track: Digitalize the Past
Word Count: 994 words

PRESENTED TO:
SparkJam 2025
Judging Panel

TEAM 13 : LUCKYDUX
Samuel Ye, Elaine Chen,
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LUCKYDUX

Project Overview

Introduction 01

Problem Framing 02

Research and Discovery 03

Ideation and Initial Concepts 04

Mentor Meetings 05

Implementing Feedback 06

The Prototype 07

Reflections 08

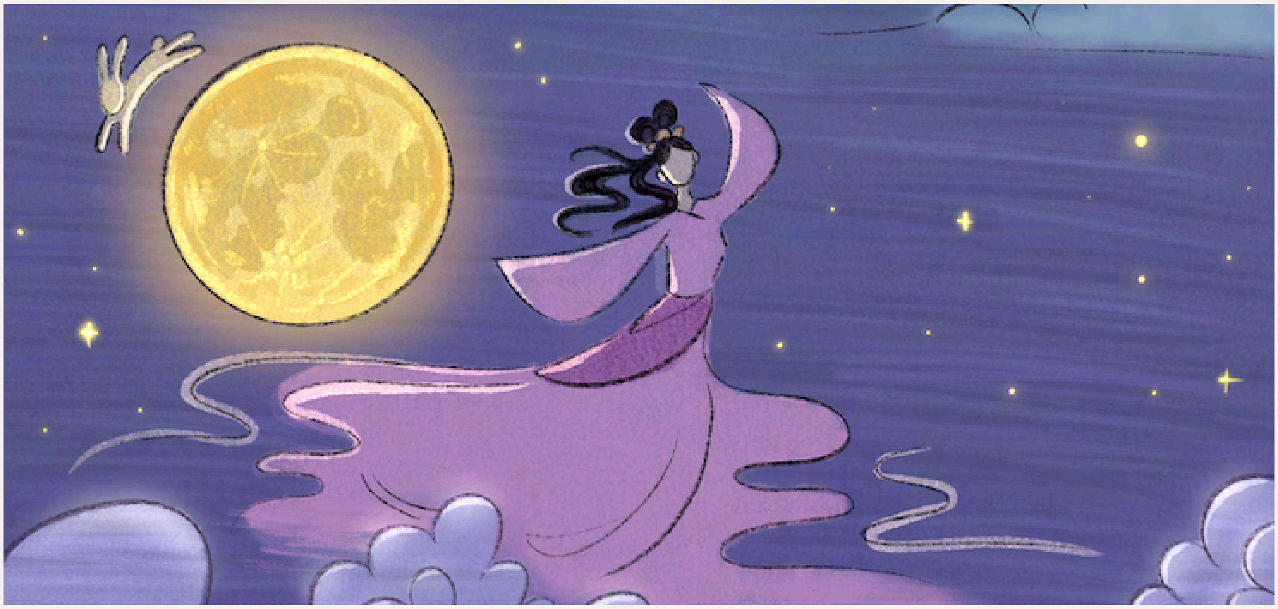
Citations 09

AI Use 10

Introduction

An interactive website, Moonlit Memories, reimagines the story behind the Mid-Autumn Festival through a modern-day lens. With interactive storytelling and 2D hand-drawn scenes, players are immersed in a tale of tradition and culture, witnessing the legend of Chang'e and Houyi.

This project connects to the "Digitize the Past" track by preserving cultural knowledge through storytelling. We aim to create a reconnection with East Asian heritage through a personal touch, especially among children and youth who might be unfamiliar with these customs.



Problem Framing

Youth & Generational Disconnection

- Language barriers prevent storytelling, especially as youth age up and further assimilate.
- Intergenerational conflict is faced by approximately 84% of Canadian-born Chinese youth, who report feeling disconnected from heritage while navigating Western social norms (Lai, 2011, as cited in Chung, 2021).
- Mainly impacts 1st generation and later Chinese-Canadians and those who immigrated early in childhood.

Canadian multiculturalism

- In locations with higher % population of heritage East Asians, like Vancouver, opportunities to reconnect exist if sought
- However < 15% of Chinese Canadian youth actively participate in cultural festivals (Department of Canadian Heritage, 2022)
- Mid-Autumn Festival (中秋节) is celebrated by many East Asian diasporic communities
- Want to encourage youth to take part in their heritage community and bridge this generational gap

Thus,
we decided to tell the story of 中秋节 through Moonlit Memories!

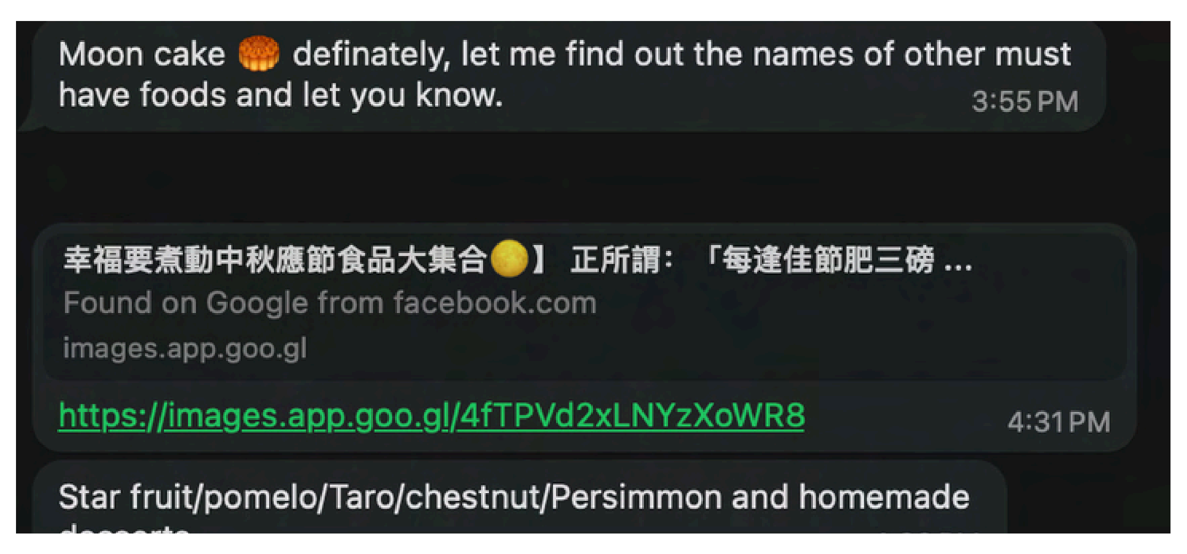
Research and Discovery

We spoke with family members about their personal experiences with the Mid-Autumn Festival.

We asked questions like:

- how did you celebrate as child?
- what traditions stood out to you?

We conducted secondary research through many sources, exploring regional practices and symbols associated with the festival, from mooncakes and lanterns to the mythology of Chang'e and Houyi.



Moon cake 🥮 definately, let me find out the names of other must have foods and let you know. 3:55 PM

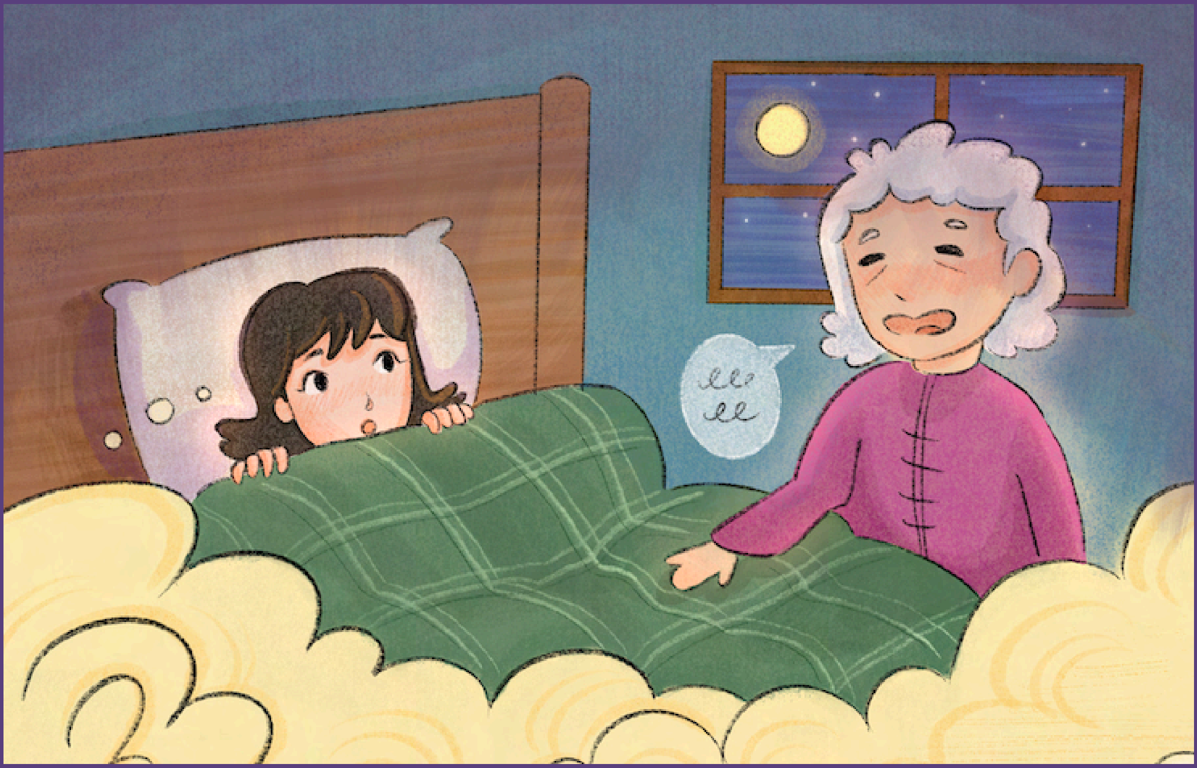
幸福要煮動中秋應節食品大集合🌕】 正所謂：「每逢佳節肥三磅 ...
Found on Google from facebook.com
images.app.goo.gl
https://images.app.goo.gl/4fTPVd2xLNYzXoWR8 4:31 PM

Star fruit/pomelo/Taro/chestnut/Persimmon and homemade

Research and Discovery

Many younger people are disengaging from traditions, seeing them as “extreme”. One blog post noted they only participate when “forced” by family.

Since traditions carry cultural values, we chose interactive storytelling, helping preserve and revive these memories.



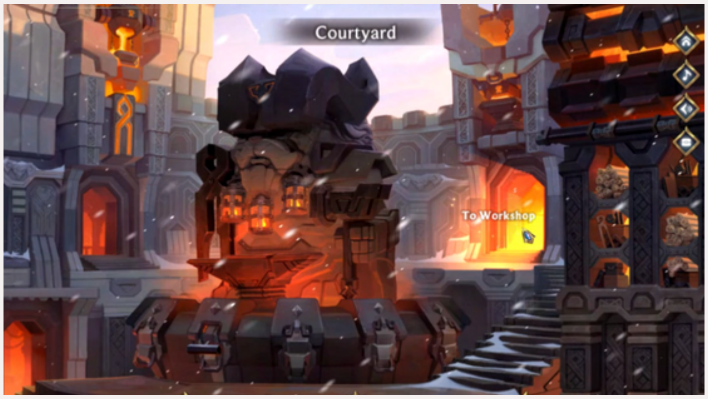
Ideation and Initial Concepts

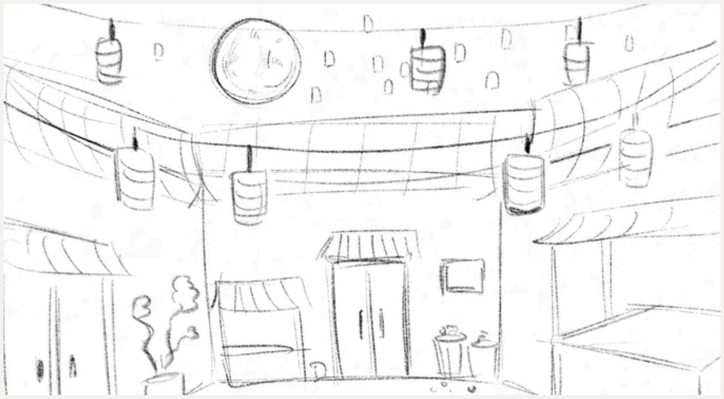
Brainstorming

Our initial design included a combination of the interactive website and the point and click journey game. The interactive scene format was chosen since would allow users to explore at their own pace and find meaning through interactions.

Inspiration

The design was inspired by The Spirit of Hearth-Home, a point-and-click minigame from League of Legends. Since the focus of The Spirit of Hearth-Home is to immerse users in the lore, we felt we could achieve a similar result by immersing users in the Mid-Autumn Festival.

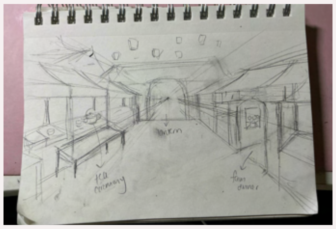


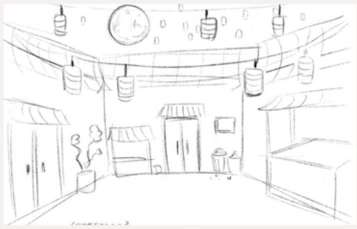


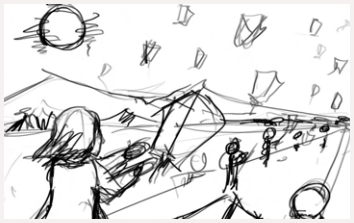
Ideation and Initial Concepts

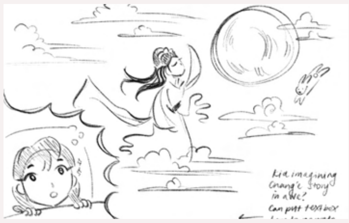
Sketches

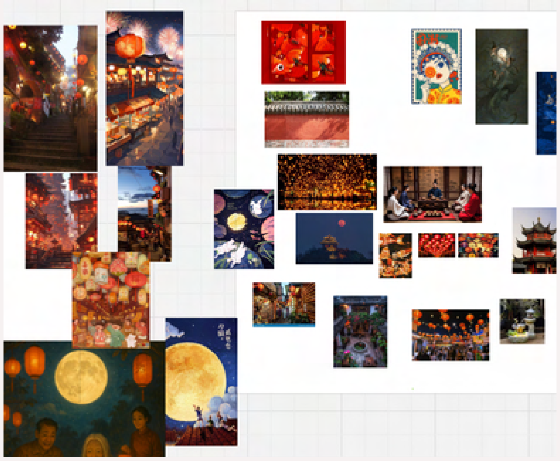
We did a few sketches of the layout of the four scenes including the child's bedroom, the courtyard, the lantern festival, and the dream of Chang'e.


tea ceremony
fam dinner






Kid imagining Chang'e story
Can put text box

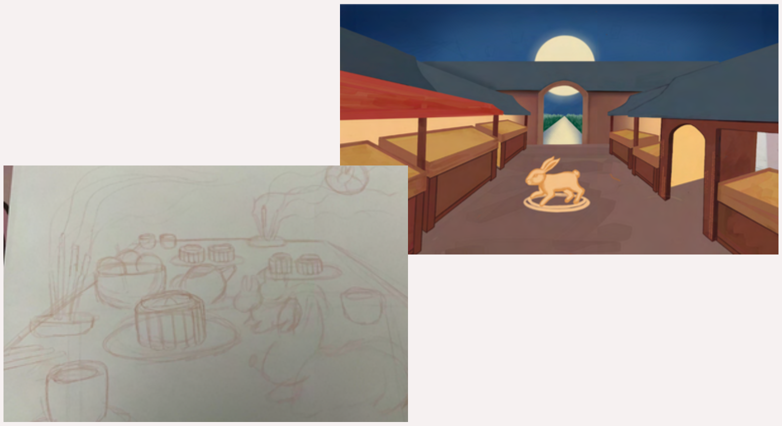


Mood Board

We created a mood board with images that reflected the look of the finished product. We looked at scenes like the lantern festival, tea ceremony, and family dinners.

Key Scenes

We picked out 3 traditions: family dinner, moon worshiping, and lantern making. Users play a young girl reconnecting with her cultural roots, exploring the traditions of the festival



Colour Palette

We used yellow and red to reflect luck in Chinese culture, and purple to evoke imagination and complement the palette. Muted tones were chosen for a softer, dreamlike feel.

🟪 🟨 🟥 🟦 🟩

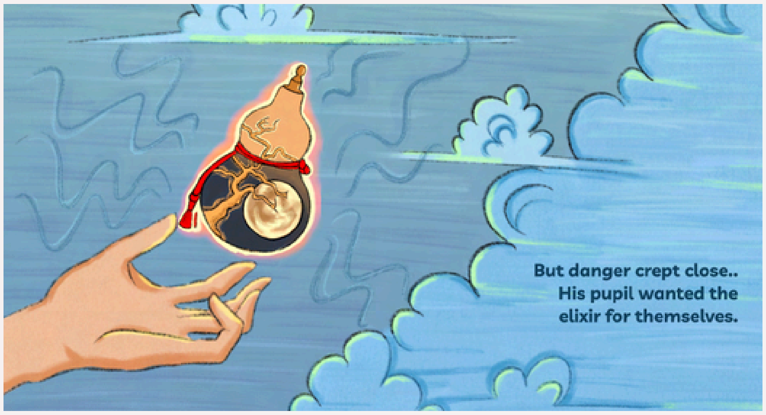
Typography

We chose a sans-serif font for the headings and body text. This is because sans-serif fonts tend to be more legible than serif fonts and give a more modern feel. We also bolded the text and were strategic with the colour of the text to create contrast between the text and the background.

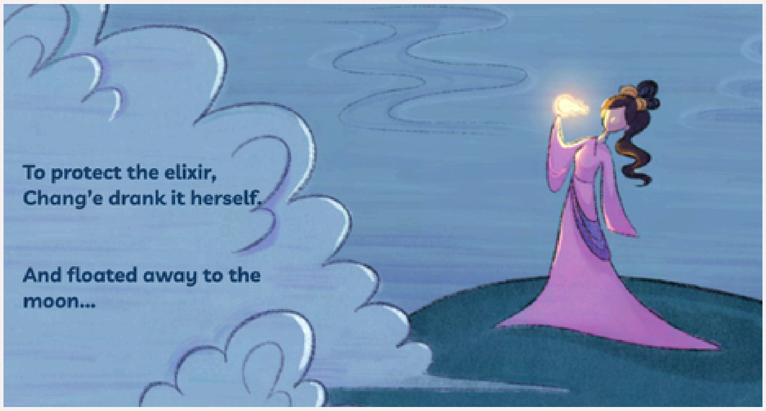
LIVVIC BOLD

LIVVIC BOLD

Mentor Meetings & Implementing Feedback

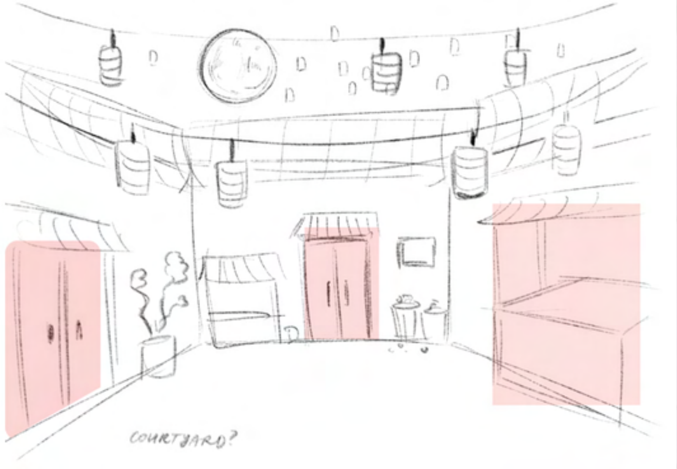

But danger crept close..
His pupil wanted the
elixir for themselves.

Based on mentor feedback, we realized that we had to pivot our idea to be more feasible within the given time frame.


To protect the elixir,
Chang'e drank it herself.
And floated away to the
moon...

1. Multiple scenes → One Dream Sequence
2. 3D Models → 2D Illustrations and Figma
3. Added our own grandparents to build a cohesive story

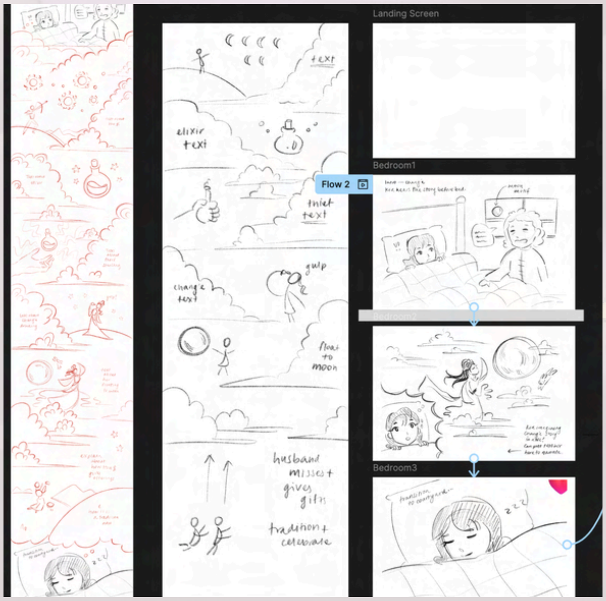
Prototype & Iterations



Our early prototype included a fully navigable interactive point-and-click for a 3D rendered courtyard; later, pivoting to a vertically scrolling interactive Figma website.

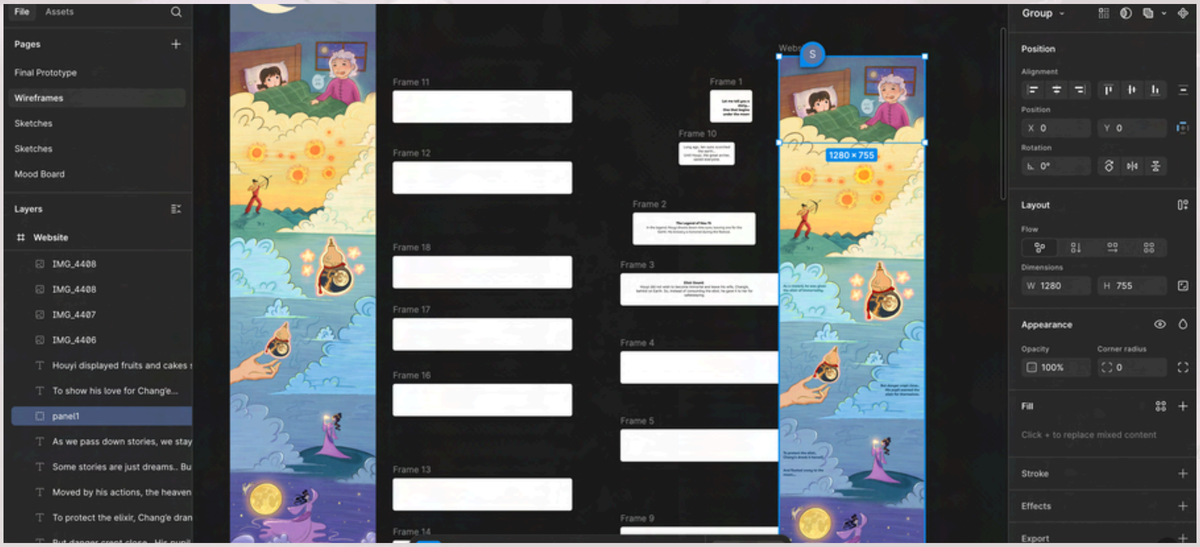
This change preserved our goal of reimagining the Mid-Autumn Festival, making the project manageable.

We used Figma to slice a tall illustration into scenes depicting the legend of Chang'e and Houyi.


Landing Screen
text
elixir text
Flow 2
Bedroom1
gulp
change text
float to moon
husband missed + gives gifts
tradition + celebrate
Bedroom3

Prototype & Iterations

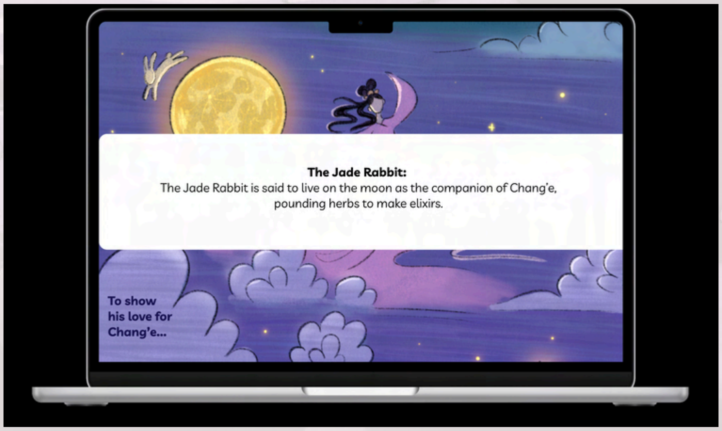
We used Smart Animate transitions for narrative text and overlays. We included interactable objects like the moon and the elixir gourd. We kept these text popups immersive but minimal to avoid drawing too much attention from the imagery.


File
Assets
Pages
Final Prototype
Wireframes
Sketches
Sketches
Mood Board
Layers
Website
IMG_4408
IMG_4408
IMG_4407
IMG_4406
Houyi displayed fruits and cakes
To show his love for Chang'e...
panel1
As we pass down stories, we stay
Some stories are just dreams.. Bu
Moved by his actions, the heaven
To protect the elixir, Chang'e dran
Frame 11
Frame 12
Frame 18
Frame 17
Frame 16
Frame 13
Frame 14
Frame 1
Frame 10
Frame 2
Frame 3
Frame 4
Frame 5
Frame 9
1280 × 755
Group
Position
Alignment
Position
X 0
Y 0
Rotation
0°
Layout
Flow
Dimensions
W 1280
H 755
Appearance
Opacity
Corner radius
100%
0
Fill
Click + to replace mixed content
Stroke
Effects
Export

Usability testing through family members and mentor feedback helped finalize the colour usage, style, and font.

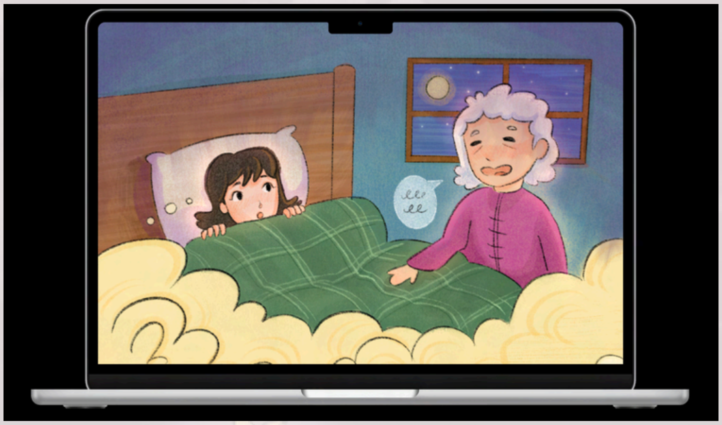
Final Solution

Moonlit Memories, an interactive web experience, reimagines the Mid-Autumn Festival as a bedtime story passed down between generations. Users follow the girl's dream as they learn about how the Mid-Autumn came to be through the legend of Chang'e and Houyi.



The Jade Rabbit:
The Jade Rabbit is said to live on the moon as the companion of Chang'e, pounding herbs to make elixirs.

To show his love for Chang'e...



We wanted this experience to feel dreamy and whimsical, like a distant memory. Through storytelling, we hope to help young people reconnect with the Mid-Autumn Festival in a way that feels meaningful.

Reflections and Learnings

What went well:

- Strong communication, regular meetings every few days
- Stuck to our strengths in illustration and research while also exploring new skills like Figma animations and prototyping

What didn’t work and lessons learned:

- Narrowing down an idea took longer than expected
- Time management: couldn’t fit courtyard illustrations and beyond into the timeline
- Difficulty putting ideas into reality due to limited experience and skills

What would you do differently next time?

- Will create a more extensive structure and deadlines for each part of the project
- Study more Figma tutorials
- Sleep when possible :)

A Note from the Creators

Hello there!

Thank you for taking the time to explore through our story behind the Mid-Autumn Festival.

As 1st, 2nd, and 3rd gen Chinese-Canadian ourselves, we've felt the disconnect for most of our lives. The story is a reflection of our experience with the Mid-Autumn Festival and our Chinese-Canadian heritage.

TIANA AND HER PARENTS

OLIVIA AND HER GRANDMA

ELAINE AND HER MOM

SAMUEL AND HIS MOM AND GRANDMA

...SHOUTOUT TO OUR PARENTS AND GRANDPARENTS.

Citations

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AI Use

We used AI (ChatGPT, GPT-4) throughout our design process to assist with brainstorming ideas and narrative writing.

Brainstorming

Prompt: “Brainstorm old practices that are lost in time through the digitization of information”

- This helped us broaden our thoughts for each track and think about what problem we wanted to solve

Narrative Writing:

Prompt: “Following the illustrated story of Chang’e and Houyi, write short captions to accompany each scene ”

- We used these captions as a first draft then edited the lines to better convey our message